



ITINERARY SPECIALLY PREPARED FOR
SRINAGAR-LADAKH- TRIP

Day 01	Arrival Delhi By International flight
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Arrive at Indira Gandhi International airport
Meet, Greet & Welcome at the airport by our office representative & transfer to hotel
On arrival Check-In at hotel
Overnight at hotel

Day 02	In Delhi
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Breakfast at hotel
Full day city tour of Delhi
Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 03	Fly Delhi-Srinagar by morning flight
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Breakfast at hotel
Check Out from hotel & transfer to airport to connect flight for Srinagar **–Flight details afterwards**

Upon arrival, Meeting & assistance on arrival and transfer to Houseboat
Later check in to Houseboat

Enjoy a Shikhara ride on Dal Lake – Approx. 45mins; - Dal Lake has rightfully become an icon of Kashmir. A Himalayan urban lake, it has five basins and a number of channels that are well linked with each other. There are plenty of fishes in Dal Lake and fishery is the second largest industry of the region centered on the lake. The sparkling quiet waters of Dal surrounded by snow-capped mountains on its three sides, undoubtedly mark it as one of the most beautiful lakes of India. It is also the second largest lake in the State of Jammu and Kashmir with numerous gardens and orchards all along its shores. Houseboats form an indelible part of the scenery of the Dal Lake that are always ready to take tourists to a romantic and peaceful ride of the lake and soothe their nerves as the houseboat floats over the slightly rippling waters. They also offer some of the most exotic views of the splendid scenery of the Dal Lake.

There are Shikaras that look like small ornate versions of the gondolas of Venice that offers ferry rides to and from the banks of the lake to the houseboats. The shores of the Lake houses the distinct Moghul monuments and the campus of the Kashmir University while the two hillocks overlooking the lake house Shankar Acharya and Hari Parbat temples.

Stop at a Houseboat for Tea/Coffee during Shikara Ride we will get it organized

Dinner & Overnight on Houseboat

Day 04

In Srinagar

Breakfast on board

Check Out from houseboat & proceed for city tour of Srinagar

Morning city tour of Srinagar – Start your tour with Mughal Gardens visiting Nishat Bagh (Abode of pleasure) built by Asif Khan brother in law of Jehangir in 1628 AD. And Shalimar Bagh (Abode of love) built by Jehangir in 1616 for his wife Empress Noor Jehan. All the gardens are situated on the bank of Dal Lake with the Zabarwan Mountains in the background. The distance from Srinagar to the said gardens is about 12 and 15 kms respectively. Enroute visit carpet-weaving factory.

Afternoon City tour visiting Fort, Jamia Masjid, Shah Hamdan Mosque and walk through the Bazaar. This historical fort is assumed to be built during the 18th century by an Afghan Governor, Atta Mohammad Khan. A long stretch of walls is seen around the hill and was constructed in 1590 by the great Mughal Emperor Akbar. The said fort can be seen from outside only as no one is allowed to enter. **Jamia Masjid** is an impressive Mosque of Srinagar, wooden structure, notable for more than 300 soaring pillars supporting the roof, each made of a single deodar tree trunk. The main gate is to the south and outer cloisters surround a spacious, green and peaceful inner courtyard. The roughly square building is 117 meters on each side, topped by four minars in the centre of each side and three pagodas – shaped minarets from which the faithful are called to prayer. The mosque has had a chequered history- first constructed by Sultan Sikander in 1385, it was enlarged in 1479 it was destroyed by a fire. The mosque was rebuilt by 1503 but was destroyed in another fire during the reign of the Mughal emperor Jehangir. It was rebuilt by the Kashmiri architect and Historian Malik Haider Chaudara but burnt down yet again in 1674 during the reign of Aurangzeb. The present mosque dates from that time but was rebuilt, on the last occasion, to the original Indo-Saracenic design.

Shah Hamdan Shrine is one of the oldest shrines in Srinagar, the wooden Shah Hamdan Shrine stands right beside the Jhelum and is noted for the paper machine work on its walls and ceilings. No nails or screws were used in the construction of this all wooden mosque. Originally built in 1395 it has been destroyed by fire in 1479 and again in 1731. The roof is covered with turf in which flowers are planted in the spring. The mosque is shaped like a cube with a pyramidal roof rising to a 38 metre high spire. Arcades, verandahs and porticos surround the large, central, wooden hall. Non-believers are not allowed inside

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 05

In Srinagar

Breakfast at hotel
Full day excursion to Gulmarg

Drive to Gulmarg (Meadow of Flowers) 2730 Mts. above sea level. The distance of 65 kms will be covered in about 1.5 hrs.

Departure Srinagar : 0900 hrs
Arrive Gulmarg : 1030 hrs

Gulmarg is one of the beautiful place that can be visited in Kashmir valley. Gulmarg literally means the meadow of flowers. Originally, Gulmarg was called Gaurimag, named after Shiva's coasts. Heavy snowfall during winter in the region makes it a favorite ski area for foreign as well as Indian residents. Anyone coming here is spellbound at the spectacular view of the snow peaks. Gulmarg has one of the best Ski slopes in the world and the highest golf course of the world with 18 holes. One can also have the view of Nanga Parbhat if weather permits. White driving towards Gulmarg, the view En route from Tangmarg to Gulmarg is fascinating.

Upon arrival in Gulmarg, walk around the famous Golf course and visit Maharani Temple & St. Mary's Church. Later proceed for a Gondola ride upto Kongdori - where guest can enjoy the scenic beauty of nature.

Clients have the option for Snow Boarding or Skiing in Gulmarg (Direct Payment Basis)

Return to Srinagar in the afternoon

Also visit of **Shankaracharya temple**

Shankaracharya temple - a Hindu temple situated on top of the Shankaracharya Hill on the Zabarwan Range in Srinagar. It is dedicated to the Hindu god, Shiva. The temple is at a height of 1,000 feet (300 m) above the valley floor and overlooks the city of Srinagar.

Return to the hotel in the evening
Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 06	Drive Srinagar-Kargil Via Sonemarg
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Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & drive to Kargil via Sonemarg

Sonmarg (Meadow of Gold) - One of the most beautiful places in Kashmir, Sonmarg was an important point in the ancient Silk Route that linked Kashmir with China. In the winter the valley is covered with powdery-white snow, which is locally known as white gold, earning it the epithet of Meadow of Gold. The rolling valley is lush green and covered with blooming flowers throughout the rest of the year and you can see snow-covered mountains rising in the distance.

Upon arrival check in at hotel

Evening at leisure

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 07	Drive Kargil-Leh 5 hrs drive
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Breakfast at hotel

Check Out & drive to Leh followed by lunch Enroute at local restaurant

Upon arrival, check in at hotel –Lunch at hotel

Evening at leisure

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 08	In Leh
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Early in the morning visit the 15th century Thiksey Monastery where you will take part in a special Morning Prayer ceremony. As the sun rises, the trumpets, gongs, prayers and chants of the monks ring out. You will be guided through the complex and see the prayer rooms with many handwritten books as well as the shrine of the goddess Tara. Afterwards you will have a private audience with the Geshes (Buddhist Doctorate Monk) to discuss or debate on Buddhism teachings and ethical practices.

Drive back to the hotel for the breakfast.

Afterwards, visit the 400-year-old Hemis Monastery of the Drukpa Kagyu School. The rich monastery is world-famous for its big monastery festival. Here, young lamas are taught yoga, tantra, philosophy, history and literature. The monastery halls are decorated with murals and statues. Followed by a hike up to Gotsang. Gotsang is a hillside hermitage with two attractive main temple buildings. The main shrine is the mountain cave in which Tantric master Gyalwang Gotsang (1189–1258) meditated. Also known as Gotsangapa, he was the enlightened Tibetan lama who first charted the pilgrim path around Mt Kailash and to whom Ladakh's Drukpa Buddhists cast back their lineage (the current Gyalwang Drukpa being his 12th incarnation).

The age-blackened cave is now hidden within the monastic building to the left as you climb up from Hemis Gumpa. The entryway is fronted with colourful murals, with the cave behind. A stone above the door is believed to be imprinted with the base of Gotsangapa's begging bowl.

You can hike here from Hemis Gumpa (about one hour to hike uphill, 30 minutes)

Return to hotel

Lunch, Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 09

In Leh

Highlight of the Tour:

Walk the Old town – Guided Heritage tour of old town



Central Asian Museum

The quiet courtyard beckons history and the fortified structure stores relics from the everlasting escapade of traditions that have transpired here over time....Bringing to life the Tibetan, Kashmiri, Baltistani and Ladhaki origins of the land.

La Las Café

An antiquated, mud-brick café, with a history rooted in romanticism! Andre Alexander, a revered historian and traveler built the innate structure for his Tibetan wife, La La and it stands true to the tale of their love, long after they've been gone.

Munshi House:

Explore the endless, prehistoric perspectives that lie within the original residence of the King's tax collector! Proudly known as the Munshi House, its primeval kitchen still stores the original earthen pots and the interior is a profound reflection of Ladakhs vernacular architecture.

Leh Palace

An audacious, architectural figure to which we all look up, the masonry walls of Leh Palace have watched over Old Town like a protective parent since the 16th century. Erected without machines or modern engineering, they have forbidden time from diminishing their age-old glory, keeping their perpendicular perfection intact to this very day.

Tsemo Namgyal

The walls of Tsemo, radiate a forgotten light. Fortified in celebration of an ancient victory, yet their presence today is quiet and elusive, that of a humble bystander who retains a distant dignity while forfeiting all the glory.

And Lastly, Food Experience Authentic Local food at a local house of Ladakh.

Return to hotel

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 10	Drive Leh-Nubra 117 kms/4-5 hrs
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Early Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & transfer to Nubra

The Nubra Valley lies in the north of Leh and is accessible over the Khardung la (18,380 ft.) one of the highest motorable roads in the world. The valley is on the trade route from Leh to Kharga via Saser and Karakoram passes.

Apart from unparalleled trekking opportunities the valley houses several Buddhist monasteries such as Sumur (Khagar) and 350 years old Diskit Gompa famous for its murals. From Khardung la drive to the village of Khardung and then through starkly beautiful countryside to the TCP at Khalsar where permits have to be registered/checked

From here one has to turn to the left of Shyok River and drive for about 24 kms over a narrow steep road to Diskit where the accommodation will be provided in Camps

Lunch, Dinner & Overnight stay

Day 11	In Nubra
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Breakfast at hotel

After breakfast walk up to Diskit monastery to witness the Morning Prayer ceremony. The Gompa is one of the highest point near the village belonging to the yellow sect (Gelugpa). Parts of the gompa, which houses 120 resident monks, are about 700 years old. The Dukhang has many statues, one of which holds the head and left arm of Turkish invader believed to be about 5000 years old

Return to hotel for lunch.

Afternoon drive 7 kms to visit Hunder Gompa. This is a small gompa belonging to the yellow sect. It is set amidst innumerable chortens and has a huge impressive statue of Chamba in the main prayer hall. The gompa was built at the time when King Namgyal came here with his wife Gyal Khatun.

Dinner & Overnight stay

Day 12	Drive Nubra-Pangong 5 hrs drive
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Breakfast at hotel
Check Out & drive to Pangong enroute enjoying all scenic beauty nature.

On arrival, check in to camps

Lunch at Camps

Evening enjoy Pangong lake & surrounding areas.

Dinner & Overnight in Camps

Day 13	Drive Pangong-Leh 5 hrs drive
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Breakfast in Camps

Morning explore surrounding areas

Lunch in camps & later drive back to Leh

On arrival, Check In at hotel - Lunch

Evening visit Shanti Stupa

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 14	Drive Leh-Uleytokpo Via Likir & Alchi
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Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & transfer to Uleytokpo Enroute visiting Likir & Alchi **followed by lunch Enroute**

First visit to village of Alchi in lower Ladakh is to be considered one of the most important cultural sites throughout the Himalayas. Consisting of four separate hamlets, the village contains numerous historic monuments of different ages and in various states of repair, the oldest and most famous of which is a monastic complex.

The 1,000-year-old three-storied Himalayan temple, with its unique murals and iconography, is a fragile wooden structure. Confirmed a World Heritage site by UNESCO, this is one of only four surviving monasteries of the 108 founded by the Great Translator, Lotsava Rinchen bZangpo in the later 10th and early 11th century. The temple preserves some of the finest examples of Kashmiri art of the period

Further proceed to Likir: The journey itself through spell bounding scenes of natural beauty is worth the effort. Snowcapped Himalayas dot the background while craggy dusty mountain ranges and the swiftly flowing Indus river as well as patches of farm make up for the fascinating foreground. At Nimu we witness the magical confluence of the two main rivers of the region - Indus & Zaskar. We make a brief stop at the Likir Monastery that houses many gigantic clay statue of Buddha in various forms. The

primary attraction is, however, their 1000-year old wall painting which make a visit more than worthwhile.

After the visits, continue drive to Uleytokpo

On arrival, check-In at hotel

Evening at leisure

Dinner & Overnight at Resort

Day 15	In Uleytokpo
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Breakfast at hotel

Morning excursion to Lamayuru - visit Lamayuru Monastery: The oldest Monastery of Ladakh. Paintings on walls are worth seeing

Lamayuru monastery popularly known as, "Yangdrung Gomp" is situated on the Leh - Srinagar highway. In ancient times there was a huge lake in this place. The great saint Nyimagung, made a prophesy saying: " May a monastery be founded in this place" and he then offered a votive water offering to all the naga serpent spirits who were the guardians of that place. The grains of that corn that formed part of this offering were carried by the waves of different places along the cliff side by the edge of the lake and when they had become mixed with the earth they sprouted forth as corn in the shape of a swastika.

At the time when a monastery was later founded there it was called Yangdrung "swastika". In the 11th century the mahasiddha Naropa came to this place and the cave where he resided and meditated is still to be seen today.

Then Rinchen Zangpo, the Translator came and built many temples and stupas and so the teachings of the Kadampa School came to flourish greatly there. Thereafter, for many years the monastery was administered by the Red Hats order of the Tibetan Buddhism., but later it was taken over by Digungpa order. Then the rituals and observances of the Digung Kargud School were introduced and the monastery received the name of Yangdrung Tharpaling

After the visit, drive back to Uleytokpo

Lunch at resort

In the late afternoon, we take group to local Ladakhi home to visit their culture followed by tea/Coffee

Dinner and Overnight at hotel

Day 16	Drive Uleytokpo-Leh 70 kms/2 hrs drive
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Breakfast at hotel

Check-out from hotel and drive by surface to Leh Enroute visiting Magnetic Hills, Sangam Point and Pathar Sahib Gurudwara, Hall of fame Museum.

On arrival check-in and lunch at hotel
Rest of time at leisure

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 17	Fly Leh-Delhi by flight
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Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & transfer to airport to connect flight for Delhi – Flight to be advised

Meeting & assistance on arrival and transfer to hotel – Room will be given till departure

Later in evening, transfer to International airport to connect flight for onward destination

Day 18	Fly Out from Delhi by International flight
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Board to your flight..... ☺

=====END OF OUR SERVICES=====

Check-in at hotel at 1400 hrs // Check-out time is 12 noon at all the hotels